

**Small Paraklesis
(Supplicatory Canon)
to the Most Holy
Theotokos**



A Poem by Theosterictus the Monk (or, according to some, by Theophanes)

The Service of the Small Paraklesis is chanted in times of distress and sorrow of soul.

It is also chanted during the first fourteen days of August (that is, the Dormition Fast of the Mother of God), alternately with the Great Supplicatory Canon.

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PRIEST: Blessed is our God...

Or if a Reader's Service:

Reader: Through the prayers of our holy fathers, Lord Jesus Christ our God, have mercy on us. Amen.

Glory to Thee, our God, glory to Thee.

O Heavenly King, Comforter, Spirit of Truth, Who art everywhere present and fillest all things, Treasury of good things and Giver of life: Come and dwell in us, and cleanse us of all impurity, and save our souls, O Good One.

Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal, have mercy on us.

Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal, have mercy on us.

Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal, have mercy on us.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, both now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. Amen.

O Most Holy Trinity, have mercy on us. O Lord, blot out our sins. O Master, pardon our iniquities. O Holy One, visit and heal our infirmities for Thy name's sake. Lord, have mercy. *(Three times)*

Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, Both now and ever....

Our Father, Who art in the Heavens, hallowed be Thy Name. Thy Kingdom come, Thy will be done, on earth as it is in Heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors; and lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from the evil one.

PRIEST: For Thine is the Kingdom...

Or if a reader's Service:

Reader: Through the prayers of our holy fathers, Lord Jesus Christ our God, have mercy on us.

Amen.

Lord, have mercy. (*Twelve times*)

Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, Both now and ever....

O come, let us worship God our King.

O come, let us worship and fall down before Christ our King and God.

O come, let us worship and fall down before Christ Himself, our King and God.

Psalm 142

O Lord, hear my prayer; give ear unto my supplication in Thy truth; hearken unto me in Thy righteousness.

And enter not into judgment with Thy servant, for in Thy sight shall no man living be justified.

For the enemy hath persecuted my soul; he hath humbled my life down to the earth.

He hath sat me in darkness as those that have been long dead, and my spirit within me is become

despondent; within me my heart is troubled.

I remembered days of old, I meditated on all Thy works, I pondered on the creations of Thy hands.

I stretched forth my hands unto Thee; my soul thirsteth after Thee like a waterless land.

Quickly hear me, O Lord; my spirit hath fainted away.

Turn not Thy face away from me, lest I be like unto them that go down into the pit.

Cause me to hear Thy mercy in the morning; for in Thee have I put my hope.

Cause me to know, O Lord, the way wherein I should walk; for unto Thee have I lifted up my soul.

Rescue me from mine enemies, O Lord; unto Thee have I fled for refuge. Teach me to do Thy will, for Thou art my God.

Thy good Spirit shall lead me in the land of uprightness. For Thy name's sake, O Lord, shalt Thou quicken me.

In Thy righteousness shalt Thou bring my soul out of affliction, and in Thy mercy shalt Thou utterly destroy mine enemies.

And Thou shalt cut off all them that afflict my soul, for I am Thy servant.

We omit: Glory ... Both now and “Alleluia, alleluia, alleluia. Glory to Thee, O God.” (Thrice) and immediately chant “God is the Lord”

And then we chant the following:

Fourth Tone

God is the Lord, and hath
appeared unto us; blessed is
He that cometh in the Name
of the Lord.

A Stichos is chanted, then “God is the Lord...” again, until all Stichoi are chanted.

Note: All words in italics are omitted by the Greeks and sung in Russian usage.

Stichos 1: O give thanks unto the Lord, *for He is good*, and call upon His Holy Name.

Stichos 2: All the nations compassed me round about, and by the name of the Lord, I warded them off.

Stichos 3: (italics are omitted by the Greeks) *I shall not die, but live, and I shall tell of the works of the Lord.*

Stichos 4: (italics are omitted by the Greeks) *The stone which the builders rejected, the same is become the head of the corner, this is the Lord's doing, and it is marvelous in our eyes.*

Troparia - Fourth Tone "Thou Who was raised up"

To God's Birthgiver let us run now most earnestly, we sinners all and wretched ones, and fall prostrate in repentance, calling from the depths of our souls: Lady, come unto our aid, have compassion upon us; hasten thou, for we are lost in a throng of transgressions; turn not thy servants away with empty hands, for thee alone do we have as our only hope.

Glory to the Father...

Repeat

Both now and ever....

O Theotokos, we shall not cease from speaking of all thy mighty acts, all we the unworthy ones; for if thou hadst not stood to intercede for us, who would have delivered us from such numerous dangers? Who would have preserved us all until now in true freedom? O Lady, we shall not turn away from thee; for thou dost always save thy servants from all manner of grief.

Psalm 50

Reader: Have mercy on me, O God,
according to Thy great mercy; and
according to the multitude of Thy
compassions blot out my transgression.

Wash me thoroughly from mine iniquity
and cleanse me from my sin.

For I know mine iniquity, and my sin is
ever before me.

Against Thee only have I sinned and
done this evil before Thee, that Thou
mightest be justified in Thy words, and
prevail when Thou art judged.

For behold, I was conceived in
iniquities, and in sins did my mother
bear me.

For behold, Thou hast loved truth; the
hidden and secret things of Thy wisdom
hast Thou made manifest unto me.

Thou shalt sprinkle me with hyssop, and
I shall be made clean; Thou shalt wash
me, and I shall be made whiter than
snow.

Thou shalt make me to hear joy and
gladness; the bones that be humbled,
they shall rejoice.

Turn Thy face away from my sins and
blot out all mine iniquities.

Create in me a clean heart, O God, and
renew a right spirit within me.

Cast me not away from Thy presence
and take not Thy Holy Spirit from me.

Restore unto me the joy of Thy
salvation, and with Thy Governing
Spirit establish me.

I shall teach transgressors Thy ways,
and the ungodly shall turn back unto
Thee.

Deliver me from blood-guiltiness, O
God, Thou God of my salvation; my
tongue shall rejoice in Thy
righteousness.

O Lord, thou shalt open my lips, and
my mouth shall declare Thy praise.

For if Thou hadst desired sacrifice, I
had given it; with whole-burnt offerings
Thou shalt not be pleased.

A sacrifice unto God is a broken spirit;
a heart that is broken and humbled God
will not despise.

Do good, O Lord, in Thy good pleasure
unto Zion, and let the walls of
Jerusalem be builded.

Then shalt Thou be pleased with a
sacrifice of righteousness, with oblation
and whole-burnt offerings.

Then shall they offer bullocks upon
Thine altar.

And then we chant the Canon:

Ode One - Tone Eight

Heirmos

Traversing the water as on dry land, and thereby escaping from the toils of Egypt's land, the Israelites cried aloud, proclaiming: Unto our God and Redeemer let us now sing.

Most Holy Mother of God, save us.

By many temptations am I distressed; in search of salvation, unto thee have I taken flight; O Mother of the Word, thou Ever-virgin, from all ordeals and afflictions deliver me.

Most Holy Mother of God, save us.

Attacks of the passions disquiet me; my soul to repletion has been filled with despondency, Bestill them, O Maiden, with the

calmness of thine own Son and thy God, O all-blameless one.

Glory to the Father...

To Christ God, the Savior, thou gavest birth; I beg thee, O Virgin, from afflictions deliver me; for now, unto thee I flee for refuge, bringing to thee both my soul and my reasoning.

Both now and ever...

Diseased is my body and my soul; do thou make me worthy of divine guidance and thy care, O thou who alone art God's Mother, for thou are good and the Birthgiver of the Good.

Ode Three

Heirmos

Of the vault of heavens art Thou,
O Lord, Fashioner; so, too, of the
Church art Thou founder. Do Thou
establish me in unfeigned love for
Thee, Who art the height of things
sought for, the staff of the faithful,
O Thou Only Friend of man.

Most Holy Mother of God, save us.

I have thee as the shelter and the
defense of my life, thee, the
Theotokos and Virgin; pilot and
govern me into thy sheltered port,
for thou art author of good things
and staff of the faithful, O thou
only lauded one.

Most Holy Mother of God, save us.

I beseech thee, O Virgin, do thou
dispel far from me all of the
distress of despair and turbulence
in my soul; for thou, O Bride of

God, hast given birth to the Lord
Christ, Who is Prince of peace, O
thou only all-blameless one.

Glory to the Father...

Since thou brought forth Him
Who is our Benefactor, the cause
of good, from the wealth of thy
loving-kindness do thou pour forth
on all; for thou canst do all things,
since thou didst bear Christ, the
One Who is mighty in power, for
blessed of God art thou.

Both now and ever...

With most grievous diseases and
with corrupt passions, too, I am
put to trial, O Virgin, come thou
unto mine aid; for I know thee to
be an inexhaustible treasure of
unfailing healing, O only all-
blameless one.

Preserve and save, O Theotokos,
thy servants from every danger;
after God do all of us for refuge
flee unto thee; a firm rampart art
thou and our protection.

In thy good will, look thou on
me, O all-hymned Theotokos; and
do thou behold my body's grievous
infirmity, and heal thou the cause
of my soul's sorrow.

*Then the priest commemorateth those for whom the supplication is chanted
(If a reader's service, we replace this Ectenia with: "Lord, have mercy." (Twelve times))*

Priest: Have mercy on us, O God, according to Thy great mercy, we pray Thee, hearken and have mercy.

The choir, after each petition:

Lord, have mercy, Lord have mercy, Lord have Mercy.

--Again we pray for pious and Orthodox Christians.

--Again we pray for our Bishop *(Name)*, and for all our brotherhood in Christ.

--Again we pray for mercy, life, peace, health, salvation, visitation, pardon and remission of the sins of the servants of God, all pious and

Orthodox Christians who dwell and sojourn in this city, the parishioners and benefactors of this holy temple, and all that serve, chant, labour and gather herein; and for the servants of God *(Names)*, and for the forgiveness of their every transgression, both voluntary and involuntary.

--For a merciful and man-befriending God art Thou, and unto Thee do we send up glory, to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.

Choir: Amen.

We then chant the following Sessional Hymn:

Second Tone “Seeking things on high”

O fervent advocate, invincible battlement, fountain of mercy,
and sheltering retreat for the world, earnestly we cry to thee:
Lady Mother of God, hasten thou, and save us from all
imperilment; for thou alone art our speedy protectress.

Ode Four - Eighth Tone

Heirmos

I have hearkened and heard, O Lord, of Thy dispensation's most awesome mystery; and I came to knowledge of Thy works, and I sang the praise of Thy Divinity.

Most Holy Mother of God, save us.

Lull the tempest of all my sins, and bestill the raging of passions with thy calm; for progenitress art thou of Him Who is Lord and Helmsman, O thou Bride of God.

Most Holy Mother of God, save us.

O bestow, out of the abyss of thy great compassion, on me, thy suppliant; for thou brought forth One compassionate Who is Savior of all who sing hymns to thee.

Glory to the Father...

While delighting, O spotless one, in thy many favors, a hymn of thankfulness do we all raise up in song to thee, knowing thee to be the Mother of our God.

Both now and ever...

Having thee as our staff and hope, and as our salvation's unshaken battlement, from all manner of adversity are we then redeemed, O thou all-lauded one.

Ode FIVE

Heirmos

Lord, enlighten us by Thy
precepts and by Thy commands;
and by the power of Thy lofty arm
bestow Thy peace upon us all,
since Thou art the Friend of man.

Most Holy Mother of God, save us.

Pure one, fill my heart with
rejoicing unto plentitude; and
grant thine undefiled felicity, since
thou didst give birth unto Him Who
is the cause of joy.

Most Holy Mother of God, save us.

Come, deliver us out of dangers,
O pure Mother of God, since thou
art mother of deliverance, and of

the peace which doth surpass all
human reasoning.

Glory to the Father...

Dissipate the gloom of my
trespasses, O Bride of God, with
the clear brightness of thy
radiance; for thou didst bear the
Light divine which was before all
time.

Both now and ever...

Heal me, O pure one, of the
sickness which the passions bring,
and make me worthy of thy
guardiancy, and by thy prayers and
intercessions grant health to me.

Ode Six

Heirmos

Entreaty do I pour forth unto the Lord, and to Him do I proclaim all my sorrows, for many woes fill my heart to repletion, and lo, my life unto Hades hath now drawn nigh; like Jonah do I pray to Thee: Raise me up from corruption, O Lord my God.

Most Holy Mother of God, save us.

My nature, held by corruption and by death, has He saved from out of death and corruption, for unto death He Himself hast submitted. Wherefore, O Virgin, do thou intercede with Him Who is in truth thy Lord and Son to redeem me from enemies' wickedness.

Most Holy Mother of God, save us.

I know thee as the protection of my life and most safe fortification,

O Virgin; disperse the horde of my many temptations, and put to silence demonic audacity, unceasingly I pray to thee: from corruption of passions deliver me.

Glory to the Father ...

A bulwark of safe retreat art thou to us, and of souls art thou the perfect salvation, and a relief in distresses, O Maiden, and in thy light do we ever exult with joy. O Lady, do thou also now, from all passions and perils deliver me.

Both now and ever ...

Bedridden, I lie supine with sickness now, and no healing for my flesh is existent except for thee, who didst bear the world's Savior, our God, the Healer of every infirmity; I pray to thee, for thou are good: from corruption of illnesses raise me up.

Preserve and save, O Theotokos,
thy servants from every danger;
after God do all of us for refuge
flee to thee; a firm rampart art
thou and our protection.

O spotless one, who
inexpressibly in the last days didst
by a word bring forth the Word, do
thou make request of Him, as one
who hath motherly boldness.

*Then the priest commemorateth those for whom the supplication is chanted
(If a reader's service, we replace this Ectenia with: "Lord, have mercy." (Twelve times))*

Priest: Have mercy on us, O God, according to Thy great mercy, we pray Thee, hearken and have mercy.

The choir, after each petition:

Lord, have mercy, Lord have mercy, Lord have Mercy.

--Again we pray for pious and Orthodox Christians.

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--For a merciful and man-befriending God art Thou, and unto Thee do we send up glory, to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.

Choir: *Amen.*

Kontakion *Second Tone*

O protection of Christians
that cannot be put to shame,
mediation unto the Creator
most constant: O despise not
the suppliant voices of those
who have sinned; but be
thou quick, O good one, to
come unto our aid, who in
faith cry unto thee:

Hasten to intercession, and
speed thou to make
supplication, thou who dost
ever protect, O Theotokos,
them that honor thee.

Then we chant the First Antiphon of the Hymns of Ascent:

Fourth Tone

From my youth do many
passions war against me, but
do Thou Thyself defend and
save me, O my Savior. *(Twice)*

Ye haters of Zion shall be
shamed by the Lord; for, like
grass, by the fire shall ye be
withered. *(Twice)*

Glory to the Father...

In the Holy Spirit, every soul
is quickened, and through
cleansing is exalted and

made radiant by the Triple
Unity in a hidden sacred
manner.

Both now and ever...

By the Holy Spirit, the
streams of grace gush forth,
watering all creation for the
begetting of life.

Prokeimenon

Fourth Tone

I shall commemorate thy
name in every generation
and generation. *(Twice, first the
clergy, then the choir)*

Hearken, O daughter, and
see, and incline thine ear;
and forget thine own people,
and thy father's house; and
the King shall greatly desire
thy beauty.

I shall commemorate thy
name in every generation
and generation.

*And again, the clergy the first part, and
the choir the second part:*

I shall commemorate thy
name...

in every generation and
generation.

Priest: And that we may be deemed worthy to hear the holy Gospel, let us beseech the Lord our God.

Choir: Lord, have mercy, Lord have mercy, Lord have mercy.

Priest: Wisdom, aright! Let us hear the Holy Gospel. Peace be unto all!

Choir: And to thy spirit.

Priest: The reading is from the holy Gospel according to Saint Luke.

Choir: Glory to Thee, O Lord, glory to Thee.

Priest: Let us attend.

The Holy Gospel - (Luke 1:39-49; 56)

In those days, Mary arose and went into the hill country with haste, into a city of Judah, and entered the house of Zacharias and greeted Elizabeth. And it came to pass that, when Elizabeth heard the salutation of Mary, the babe leaped in her womb; and Elizabeth was filled with the Holy Spirit. And she spake out with a loud voice and said, "Blessed are thou among women, and blessed is the fruit of thy womb! And whence is this to me, that the mother of my Lord should come to me? For behold, as soon as the voice of thy salutation sounded in my ears, the babe

leaped in my womb for joy. And blessed is she who believed, for there shall be a fulfillment of those things which have been spoken to her from the Lord." And Mary said: "My soul doth magnify the Lord, and my spirit hath rejoiced in God my Savior. For He hath looked upon the lowliness of His handmaiden; for behold, from henceforth all generations shall call me blessed. For the Mighty One hath done great things to me, and holy is His name". And Mary abode with her about three months, and returned to her house.

Choir: Glory to Thee, O Lord, glory to Thee.

And then we chant the following hymns:

Second Tone

Glory to the Father and the
Son and the Holy Spirit

O Father, Word, and Spirit,
the Trinity in Unity: blot out
the multitude of mine
offences.

Both now and ever...

By the intercessions of the
Theotokos, O Merciful One,
blot out the multitude of my
offences.

Have mercy on me, O God,
according to Thy great
mercy; and according to the
multitude of Thy
compassions blot out my
transgression.

Sixth Tone: "Having placed their every hope"

O entrust me not, I pray, to any human protection, O our Lady, holy one, but do thou accept the prayer of thy suppliant. Sorrow has fettered me, and I am unable to endure and bear the demons' darts; a shelter have I not, neither place to run, I, the wretched one. Embattled from all sides am I, and no consolation have I but thee. Mistress of creation, protection and hope of faithful ones: Turn not away when I pray to thee; do that which will profit me.

From thee is no one is turned away ashamed and empty who doth run to thee for refuge, O pure Virgin Theotokos; but he asketh the favor and receiveth the gift from thee, unto the profit of his own request.

The transformation of the afflicted and the relief of those in sickness are thou in truth, O Virgin Theotokos; save thy people and thy flock, thou who are the peace of the embattled and who art the calm of the storm-driven, the only protectress of those who believe.

The priest chants “Save O God”. The Ectenia is not said.

(If a reader’s service, we replace this Ectenia with: “Lord, have mercy.” (Twelve times))

Priest: Save, O God, Thy people, & bless Thine inheritance; visit Thy world with mercy & compassions; exalt the horn of Orthodox Christians, & send down upon us Thine abundant mercies:

through the intercessions of our immaculate Lady Theotokos & Ever-Virgin Mary; through the power of the life-creating Cross; through the mediations of the honorable, heavenly Bodiless hosts; of the honorable, glorious Prophet, Forerunner & Baptist John; of the holy, glorious & all-praised Apostles; [if one of the 12 Ap. or Evang., of the holy Apostle & Evangelist N. & the Other holy, glorious, & all-praised apostles];

of our fathers among the saints & great ecumenical teachers &

hierarchs: Basil the Great, Gregory the Theologian, & John Chrysostom; our father among the saints Nicholas, Archbishop of Myra in Lycia, the Wonderworker;

the holy Equals-of-the-Apostles Methodius & Cyril, Teachers of the Slavs; of the holy right believing & Equals-of-the Apostles Great Prince Vladimir, & the blessed Princess of Russia, Olga; of our fathers among the saints, the Wonderworkers of All Russia: Michael, Peter, Alexis, Jonah, Philip, Hermogenes, Macarius, Demetrius, Metrophanes, Tikhon, Theodosius, Joasaph, Pitirim, Hermogenes, Innocent & John;

the holy Hieromartyrs & confessors: Tikhon, Patriarch of Moscow, Vladimir of Kiev, Benjamin & Joseph of Petrograd, Peter of

Krutitsa, Cyril of Kazan, Agathangel of Yaroslavl, Andronicus of Perm, Hermogenes of Tobolsk, the priests John, John, Peter, & Philosoph, & all the New-Hieromartyrs & Confessors of the Russian Church;

the holy, glorious & victorious martyrs: the holy, glorious Great Martyr, Trophy-bearer, & Wonderworker George; the holy Great-martyr & Healer Panteleimon; the holy Great Martyr Barbara;

and the holy right-believing Russian Princes & Passion-bearers Boris, Gleb & Igor; & the holy right believing Passion-bearers: Tsar-Martyr Nicholas, Tsaritsa Alexandra, Crown Prince Alexis, Princesses Olga, Tatiana, Maria, & Anastasia ; & the holy new martyrs: Grand Duchess Elizabeth & Nun Barbara & all the New Martyrs of Russia;

our holy & God-bearing fathers Anthony & Theodosius of the Kiev Caves Monastery, Sergius the Abbot of Radonezh, Seraphim of Sarov,

Job, Abbot & Wonderworker of Pochaev,

of the holy righteous John of Kronstadt, of holy Blessed Xenia of Petersburg, of our holy & God-bearing fathers: Herman of Alaska, Paisius Velichkovsky, Leo, Macarius, Ambrose, & the other Elders of Optina, the Hierarchs Innocent of Moscow, Nicholas of Japan, John of Shanghai & San Francisco, Nectarios of Pentapolis, Jonah of Manchuria ..

of our holy & God-bearing

fathers: Kosmas of Zographou & Zaire, Elder Porphyrios & Elder Paisios of Mt Athos, Father Silouan of Mount Athos and his disciple, Father Sophronius, holy Mother Mary of Egypt, holy Matrona the Blessed of Moscow, holy Patriarch Joseph the All-Comely, the Holy Prophet Daniel, the holy Great-Martyr James of Persia, the holy martyr Timothy of Esphigmenou, our holy Father Nicephorus the Leper, the Holy Prince Alexander

Nevski, our Holy father Luke the
surgeon, the Holy New Martyr
Ephrem of Nea Makri,
of ____, patron(s) & protector(s) of
this temple, & Saint(s) ____ who we
remember this day, **of the holy &
righteous Ancestors of God
Joachim & Anna**, & of all the saints;

We pray Thee, O Lord plenteous
in mercy, hearken unto us sinners
that pray unto Thee, & have mercy
on us.

EXCLAMATION:

**Through the mercy and compassions and love for mankind of
Thine Only-begotten Son, with Whom Thou art blessed, together
with Thy most holy, and good, and life-creating Spirit, now and
ever, and unto the ages of ages.**

Choir: *Amen.*

And then we resume the chanting of the Canon:

Ode Seven - Eighth Tone

Heirmos

Once from out of Judea did the
Children go down to the land of
Babylon; the fire of the furnace
they trampled down while
chanting by their faith in the
Trinity: O God of our Fathers,
blessed are Thou.

Most Holy Mother of God, save us.

Having willed thus, O Savior, to
dispense our salvation in Thine
economy, Thou dwelt within the
Maid's womb, and unto all creation
as protectress Thou showed her
forth; O God of our Fathers,
blessed are Thou.

Most Holy Mother of God, save us.

Make request, O pure Mother, to
thy Son who hath willed to grant
mercy unto us, to rescue from

transgressions and from the soul's
defilement those who cry out most
faithfully: O God of our Fathers,
blessed are Thou.

Glory to the Father...

A fount of incorruption and a
tower of safety is she who gave
Thee birth; a treasure of salvation
and portal of repentance hast Thou
proved her to them that shout: O
God of our Fathers, blessed are
Thou.

Both now and ever...

Deign to grant restoration from
diseases of body and soul to those
who run to thy divine protection
with faith, O Theotokos, and thus
grant them recovery; for Mother of
Christ our Savior are thou.

Ode Eight

Heirmos

The King of Heaven, Whom all
the hosts of Angels hymn with
their chants and praises of glory,
praise ye and exalt Him to the ages
forever.

Most Holy Mother of God, save us.

Do not disdain those who seek
the help that thou dost grant, for,
O Virgin Maiden, they do hymn
thee, and they all exalt thee unto
ages forever.

Most Holy Mother of God, save us.

On all who hymn thee with faith,
O Virgin, and exalt thy truly
ineffable Offspring, thou pourest
forth a great abundance of thy
cures and healings.

Glory to the Father...

All the diseases that plague my
soul dost thou make well, and the
sufferings of the flesh thou healest
also; wherefore, O thou Maiden
full of grace, I glorify thee.

Both now and ever...

All the assaultings of the
temptations dost thou quell, and
the onslaughts of the passions dost
thou banish, wherefore do we
hymn thee to all ages, O Virgin.

Heirmos

Most rightly we confess thee as
our God's Birthgiver, we who
through thee have been saved, O
thou Virgin most pure; with choirs
of bodiless Angels, thee do we
magnify.

Most Holy Mother of God, save us.

The torrent of my weeping spurn
not with refusal, for thou didst give
birth to Him Who doth take away
all tears from every face, O thou
Virgin, for He is Christ indeed.

Most Holy Mother of God, save us.

Do thou, O Virgin Maiden, fill my
heart with gladness, for thou are
she who received all the fullness of
joy, and made to vanish away all
sorrow of sinfulness.

Most Holy Mother of God, save us.

A haven and protection, and a
wall unshaken, and a rejoicing and
shelter and place of retreat do
thou become, O thou Virgin, for
those who flee to thee.

Glory to the Father...

Illumine with the radiance of thy
light, O Virgin, all those who
piously call thee the Mother of
God, and do thou banish away all
darkness of ignorance.

Both now and ever...

Brought low am I, O Virgin, in a
place of sickness, and in a dwelling
of anguish; grant healing to me,
transforming all of my illness into
full healthfulness.

And then we chant, in the Eighth Tone:

It is truly meet to call thee
blessed, the Theotokos, the
ever-blessed and all
immaculate and Mother of
our God. More honorable
than the Cherubim, and

beyond compare more
glorious than the Seraphim,
thee who without corruption
gavest birth to God the
Word, the very Theotokos,
thee do we magnify.

While censuring the church, we chant the following Megalynaria in the Eighth Tone:

Higher than the heavens
above art thou, and thou art
much purer than the
radiance of the sun; for thou
hast redeemed us out of the
curse that held us, O
Mistress of creation, thee do
we magnify.

From the great abundance of
all my sins, ill am I in body,
ailing also am I in soul. Thee
have I as refuge; do thou
therefore help me, O hope of
all the hopeless, for thou art
full of grace.

O Lady and Mother of Christ
our God, receive supplication
from us wretches who beg of

thee that thou make entreaty
unto the One born from thee;
O Mistress of creation, do
thou intercede for us. Now
we chant with eagerness
unto thee with this ode most
joyful, O all-hymned Mother
of our God; together with the
Baptist and all the saintly
choirs, beseech, O
Theotokos, that we find
clemency.

Speechless be the lips of the
impious who refuse to
reverence thy revered icon
which is known by the name
Directress, and which has
been depicted for us by the
Apostle Luke the Evangelist.

O all ye arrays of Angelic
Hosts, with the holy Baptist,
the Apostles' twelve-
numbered band, all the

Saints together, as well as
God's Birthgiver, pray make
ye intercession for our
deliverance.

Reader:

Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal, have mercy on us.

Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal, have mercy on us.

Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal, have mercy on us.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, both now and
ever, and unto the ages of ages. Amen.

O Most Holy Trinity, have mercy on us. O Lord, blot out our sins. O Master, pardon
our iniquities. O Holy One, visit and heal our infirmities for Thy name's sake.

Lord, have mercy. *(Three times)*

Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, Both now and ever...

Our Father, Who art in the Heavens, hallowed be Thy Name. Thy Kingdom come,
Thy will be done, on earth as it is in Heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and
forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors; and lead us not into temptation, but
deliver us from the evil one.

PRIEST: For Thine...

Then we chant the following Troparia:

Sixth Tone

Have mercy on us, O Lord,
have mercy on us; for
lacking as we are in all
defense, this supplication do
we sinners offer unto Thee,
as our Master: Have mercy
on us.

Glory to the Father...

Lord, have mercy on us, for
in Thee have we placed all
our trust. Be not wroth with
us greatly, nor do Thou
remember our iniquities; but
look upon us even now,
since Thou art

compassionate, and do thou
redeem us from our enemies.
For Thou art our God and we
Thy people; all are the works
of Thy hands, and upon Thy
Name have we called.

Both now and ever...

Theotokion

Do thou open the portal of
compassion to us, O most
blessed Theotokos; for
hoping in thee, let us not
fail, we pray; through thee
may we be delivered from
adversities, for thou art the
salvation of the Christian
race.

Lord, have mercy. *(Twelve times)*

*Then the priest commemorateth those for whom the supplication is chanted
(If a reader's service, we replace this Ectenia with: "Lord, have mercy." (Twelve times))*

Priest: Have mercy on us, O God, according to Thy great mercy, we pray Thee, hearken and have mercy.

The choir, after each petition:

Lord, have mercy, Lord have mercy, Lord have Mercy.

--Again we pray for pious and Orthodox Christians.

--Again we pray for our Bishop *(Name)*, and for all our brotherhood in Christ.

--Again we pray for mercy, life, peace, health, salvation, visitation, pardon and remission of the sins of

the servants of God, all pious and Orthodox Christians who dwell and sojourn in this city, the parishioners and benefactors of this holy temple, and all that serve, chant, labor and gather herein; and for the servants of God *(Names)*, and for the forgiveness of their every transgression, both voluntary and involuntary.

--For a merciful and man-befriending God art Thou, and unto Thee do we send up glory, to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.

Choir: *Amen.*

The Dismissal

The Priest makes the Dismissal:

Priest: Glory to thee, O Christ our God and our hope, glory to thee.

People: Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit: both now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen. Lord, have mercy; Lord, have mercy; Lord, have mercy. Father (*Master, if a bishop is present, whether he serve of not*), bless.

Priest: May Christ our true God, (*insert the appointed characteristic phrase, on Sundays, 'Who arose from the dead'*), through the intercessions of His most pure Mother; (*and the rest*) of our father among the saints, John Chrysostom, Archbishop of Constantinople; (and of the saint(*s*) *whose temple it is and whose day it is*); of the holy and Righteous Ancestors of God, Joachim and Anna; and of all the saints: have mercy on us and save us, for He is good and the Lover of mankind.

People: Amen.

And then we venerate the icon of the Theotokos.

When it is not the Dormition Fast, we chant the following Troparia with prostrations

Second Tone “When from the Tree”

All those who in faith flee to thee, with thy mighty hand dost thou shelter, O pure one, as thou art good; no one else have we who sin as a perpetual intercession with our God in dangers and sorrows, we who have been burdened down with our abundant sins, Mother of God in the highest.

Wherefore, we all fall down before thee; rescue us, thy servants, from adversities.

Joy of all that sorrow are thou, and of the oppressed a protectress, and nurture of all the poor, comfort unto the

estranged, a staff are thou of the blind, visitation of all the sick, a shelter and succor unto those brought down by pain, helper of orphaned ones: Mother of God in the Highest art thou, O immaculate Maiden; hasten, we beseech thee, to redeem thy slaves.

Eighth Tone

Lady, do thou receive the supplications of thy slaves, and deliver us from every affliction and necessity.

Second Tone

Unto thee do I commit my every hope, O Mother of God; guard me under thy shelter.

During the Dormition Fast, we chant the following Exapostilaria (from the conclusion of the Great Paraklesis)

Third Tone (Variant)

O ye Apostles from afar,
being now gathered together
here in the vale of
Gethsemane, give burial to
my body; and Thou, my Son
and my God, receive Thou
my spirit.

Thou art the sweetness of
Angels, the gladness of
afflicted ones, and the
protectress of Christians, O
Virgin Mother of our Lord; be
thou my helper and save me
from out of eternal torments.

I have thee as Mediatress
with the man-befriending
God; may He not censure my
actions before the hosts of
the Angels. I supplicate thee,
O Virgin, come unto my aid
most quickly.

Thou art a gold-entwined
tower and twelve-wall
encircled city, a throne
besprinkled with sunbeams,
a royal chair of the King, O
inexplicable wonder! That
thou dost milk-feed the
Master.

After the chanting of the Expostalaria, the priest says:

PRIEST: Through the prayers of our holy Fathers, Lord Jesus Christ our God, have mercy on us. Amen.